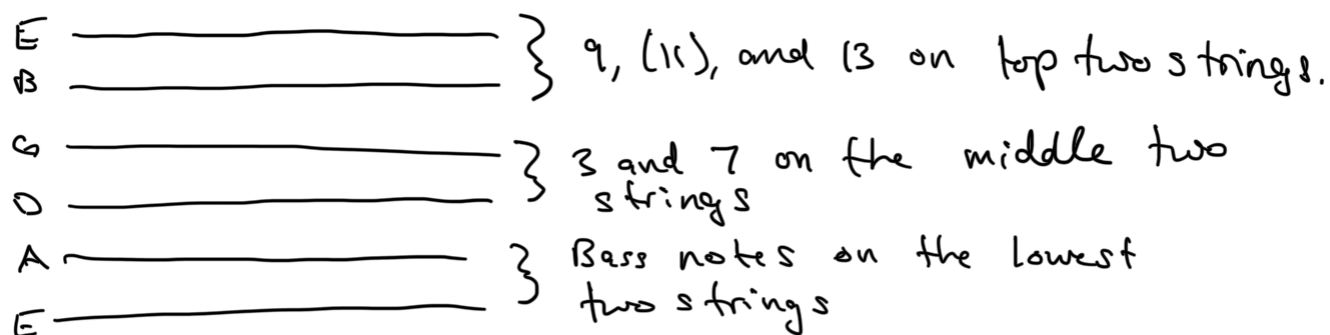
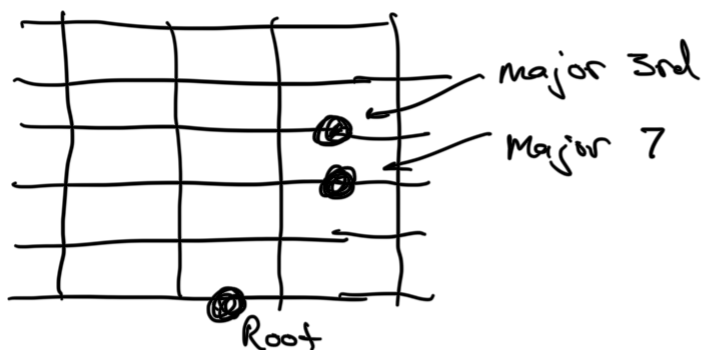


Here is one possible system for voicing chords on the guitar



To voice a chord, start by picking a bass note. We will only play one of the lowest two strings at a time.

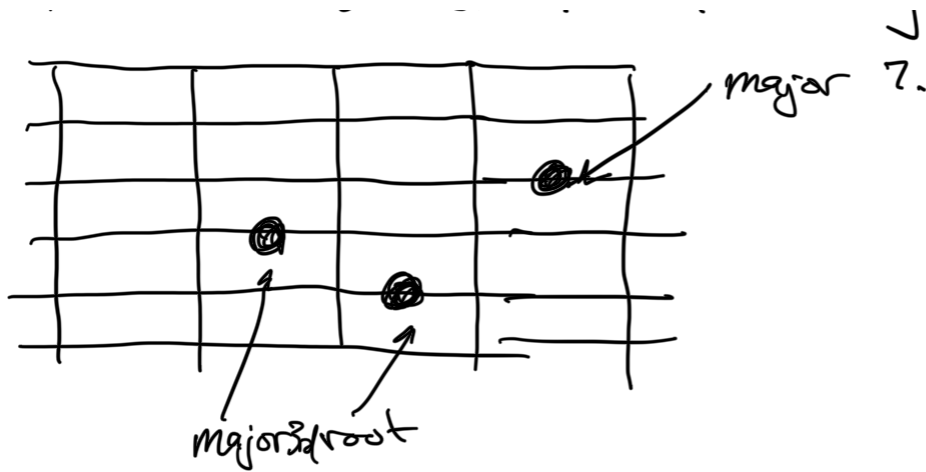
Rule: if Bass note is on E string, the third will be on the G string



The 3rd and 7th come in major and minor versions. a $C\Delta$ has both major. a $C7$ has major 3 and minor 7. a $C-7$ has both minor.

We can also lower the 7th two frets to get a 6, for example for $C6$, $C-6$.
 occasionally we may use $C-maj7$ which has a minor 3rd and major 7.

Rule: If Bass note is on A string, then the third will be on the D string.



The 3rd and 7 can be adjusted accordingly as similarly to the previous rule.

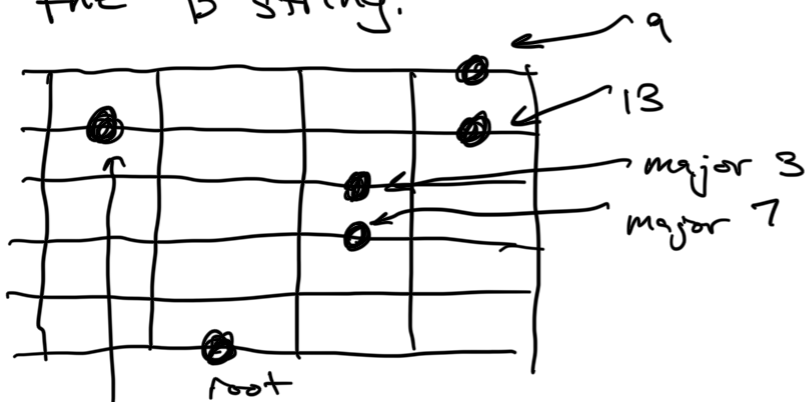
Note on 3 and 7:

Many times as a guitar player it can be useful to only play 3 and 7 on the D and G string. Use the bass notes as a reference point, but you generally won't play it if there is a bass player.

In big band playing, Freddie Green only ever played the D string on 3rd and 7th, and occasionally the G string, but no more.

Sticking to just 3 and 7 can also help when there are other chording instruments.

Rule: If bass note is on the E string then 9 is on the high E string and 11/13 is on the B string.



#11.

While 3 and 7 typically come in major and minor varieties, 9, 11, and 13 typically do not. Instead they have natural positions and can be raised or lowered as indicated.

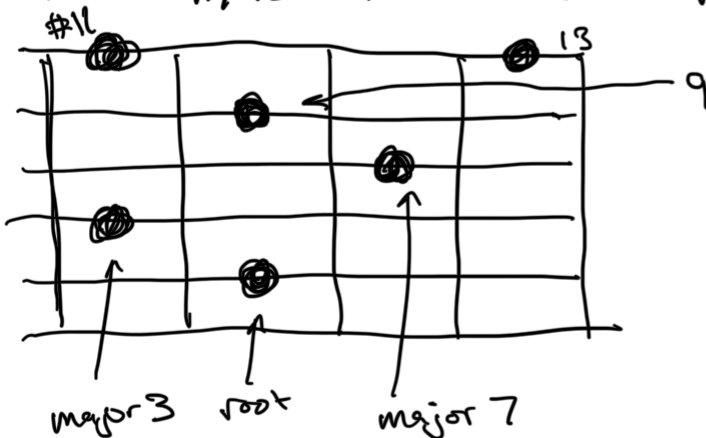
For example G7 b9 b13 has major 3rd, minor 7, a lowered 9 and a lowered 13.

Occasionally it may be useful to lower the 13 by two steps to a 5 for a more simple sound. One case where this is common is in

G-9, where the 13 could add unwanted harmonic information.

The 9 may also be lowered by two steps to the octave, for example as needed in a chord melody where the top note of the chord is important.

Rule: If the bass note is on the A string, then the 9 is on the B string and the 11/13 are on the high E string.



The 9, 11, and 13 may be altered as described previously. As with the other, it is occasionally useful to lower the 13 to a 5 for harmonic

simplicity or to guide the melody note.

One particularly useful shape is C_6^7 with the 13 moved down to the 5th. This is a quartal voicing, neglecting the root.

Occasionally we may break the rule and put the 11 on the D string by raising the major 3rd a step. This is good for chords such as $D-11$. Such voicings create a solid bar across the neck.